

Comparing Fractions

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Study the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

CUE FOCUS **Same denominator** → compare the **numerators**; more parts is bigger ($3/5 > 2/5$). **Same numerator** → **fewer parts is bigger**, because the pieces are larger ($1/3 > 1/4$). If the tops and bottoms are both different, **make a common denominator** first, then compare the numerators. Use $>$, $<$, or $=$.

Round 1 — Retrieve It

1. If the denominators are the same, what do you compare?

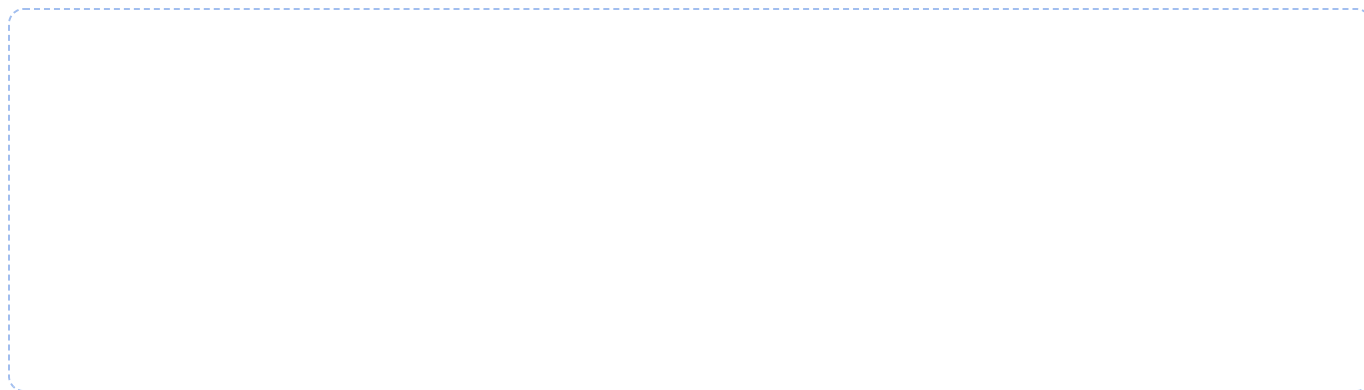
2. If the numerators are the same, which fraction is bigger?

3. Compare using $>$, $<$, or $=$: $3/5$ ____ $2/5$.

4. What do you do when the tops and bottoms are both different?

Round 2 — Sketch It

Draw two same-size bars. Shade $1/3$ on one and $1/4$ on the other. Show which fraction is bigger and write the comparison with a symbol.



Comparing Fractions — Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Answer first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 — Apply the Idea

1. Compare using $>$, $<$, or $=$: $\frac{5}{8}$ ____ $\frac{3}{8}$. How did you decide?

2. Compare using $>$, $<$, or $=$: $\frac{2}{3}$ ____ $\frac{2}{5}$. How did you decide?

3. Compare $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{2}{3}$ by making a common denominator. Show your work.

Round 4 — Reason from Evidence

Rosa says $\frac{1}{4}$ is greater than $\frac{1}{3}$ because 4 is greater than 3. Is she correct? Use same-numerator reasoning or a picture to explain.

Comparing Fractions — ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A**Articulate**

Explain the two quick rules for comparing fractions. Use the words same denominator and same numerator.

C**Connect**

Connect comparing fractions to sharing. Tell whether you would rather have $\frac{1}{3}$ or $\frac{1}{4}$ of the same pizza, and why.

E**Extend**

Compare $\frac{3}{4}$ and $\frac{5}{6}$ by making a common denominator. Show your work and write the comparison.

Confidence check. Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it.

Teacher Key — Comparing Fractions

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. The numerators (more parts is bigger).
2. The one with the smaller denominator (fewer parts, larger pieces).
3. $\frac{3}{5} > \frac{2}{5}$.
4. Make a common denominator, then compare the numerators.

Sketch It — look for

Two same-size bars: $\frac{1}{3}$ shaded covers more than $\frac{1}{4}$ shaded. Comparison written $\frac{1}{3} > \frac{1}{4}$.

Apply It

1. $\frac{5}{8} > \frac{3}{8}$. Same denominator, so compare numerators; $5 > 3$.
2. $\frac{2}{3} > \frac{2}{5}$. Same numerator, so fewer parts (thirds) are bigger than fifths.
3. $\frac{1}{2} = \frac{3}{6}$ and $\frac{2}{3} = \frac{4}{6}$, so $\frac{1}{2} < \frac{2}{3}$.

Reason from Evidence — look for

No. With the same numerator (1), fewer parts means bigger pieces, so $\frac{1}{3} > \frac{1}{4}$. A bigger denominator makes each piece smaller.

ACE — Extend look-for

Common denominator 12: $\frac{3}{4} = \frac{9}{12}$ and $\frac{5}{6} = \frac{10}{12}$, so $\frac{3}{4} < \frac{5}{6}$.

Suggested use. Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color.